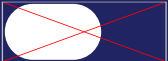


Guided Journaling: Finding your North Star



Instructions

Instructions:

- Find the nearest piece of paper, journal, old bill, take out napkin, or something to write on, and find a writing utensil.
- If you are open to it, have your cameras on for this session.
- You will be given various prompts and be asked to write about them and share.
 - Don't overthink the prompts! Let your thoughts pour out in an unorganized, stream-of consciousness. Don't worry about grammar, spelling, neatness
 - If you get stuck, acknowledge it in your writing. Maybe ask yourself why. Keep writing until instructed to move on.
- Label the sections we go through according to the title. This will help you later.
- Some sections will have opportunities to share with a small group of 2-3, and some sections will ask for volunteers to share with the larger group.



I. Opening

[Write for 3 minutes]

Think back to when you were first starting the program.

What is one word you would use to describe what you were looking forward to when you joined USDC? Why?



II. The Retro: What Has Changed?

[Write for 3 minutes]

What's different about how you work, think, or show up *nowadays* compared to when you started this program?



III. Celebrating the Wins

[Write for 3 minutes]

**What's one win from this program you're genuinely proud of,
the kind you'd tell a mentor about or put in a cover letter?**



IV. Your Core Values

[Write for 4 minutes]

What core value(s) resonate with you the most?

Come up with your own list.

Non-exhaustive examples: Authenticity, Achievement, Adventure, Authority, Autonomy, Balance, Boldness, Compassion, Challenge, Citizenship, Community, Competency, Contribution, Creativity, Curiosity, Determination, Fairness, Faith, Fame, Friendships, Fun, Growth, Happiness, Honesty, Humor, Influence, Inner Harmony, Justice, Kindness, Knowledge, Leadership, Learning, Love, Loyalty, Meaningful Work, Openness, Optimism, Peace, Pleasure, Poise, Popularity, Recognition, Reputation, Respect, Responsibility, Security, Self-Respect, Service, Spirituality, Stability, Success, Status, Trustworthiness, Wealth, Wisdom



IV. Your Core Values

[Write for 6 minutes]

What do your core values mean?

How would you actualize them?

I.e. If “learning” was one of your core values, it may look like taking a new course, seeking out a mentor, learning by doing, etc. What actionable tasks demonstrate your core values?



V. Growth Gaps and Where You Need Help

[Write for 5 minutes]

What's one thing you could use real help with right now, a skill gap, a decision, a connection, or just a thought partner?



VI. Your Statement

[Craft for 3 minutes]

Use one of the formulas below to craft your North Star statement, or feel free to improvise.

- “I came to civil service to [part I], and two years later I now understand that the real work is in [part II]”
- “My proudest win, [part III], happened because I led with [part IV]”
- “I am deeply committed to [part IV], and to seek that out, I need to grow in [part V]”
- “My north star is [part IV]. The gap between me and that vision is [part V]”
- “I came here to [part I]. To fully realize that, I need help with [part V].”
- “Two years has turned [part II] into a strength. I’ve accomplished [part III], and I am ready to be honest that [part V] is where I need help.”
- “I entered this work to [part I]. I’ve proven that through [part III]. Going forward, [part IV] will guide the decisions I make.”

